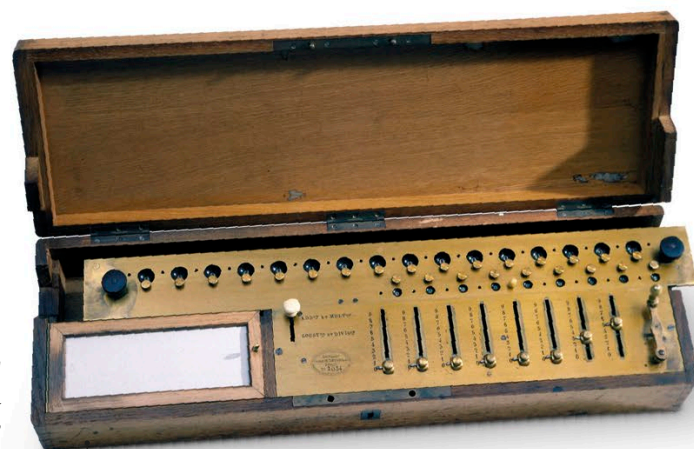


Buying and selling

The world's economy relies upon people buying and selling goods and services. Countless inventions have made it easier for us to do this, from cash registers to trolleys. In the digital age, shopping continues to change dramatically—we can now shop with just the click of a mouse or the tap of a smartphone.

EARLY CALCULATING MACHINE

French insurance agent Thomas de Colmar created the first practical adding machine, or “arithmometer,” in 1820. It could add, subtract, divide, and multiply.



Arithmometer, c.1870

Strong wooden case protects the machine.

Late 19th-century cash register from Germany



CASH REGISTER

The first cash register was patented by American bartender James Ritty, in 1879. It recorded sales and helped stop workers from pocketing money. The idea was improved upon and marketed by coal merchant John Patterson in 1884.

Ornate metal casing

SHOPPING CART

In 1936, American shop-owner Sylvan Goldman saw that shoppers bought only as much as they could carry. So, he welded baskets to a folding chair and added wheels—the shopping cart was born.



Modern-day shopping cart invented by the American Orla Watson in 1946